

GradBoost

1 Introduction

The theme that I have chosen is an app that helps recent graduates as well as international students get into entry level jobs. There are many websites which accomplish similar tasks such as LinkedIn, Glassdoor, GradCracker and more. However, where my app differs from the rest is that it is specifically based in the west midlands. Furthermore, there is extra support for international students who may struggle to get a job due to legal constraints, requiring a sponsorship, visa, lack of local work experience. These issues are often not fully addressed by competitors. LinkedIn is more focused on the networking aspect and websites like GradCracker focus on finding jobs across the country.

My main target audience are graduates and especially international students. England attracts many international students. Birmingham alone has many different universities such as BCU, University of Birmingham and Aston University. Many graduates and international students struggle to find opportunities to match their skill levels. In 2021, the graduate unemployment rate was 12% which is approximately 96,041 graduates per year. (UK Graduate Statistics, n.d.)

This is a gap in the market as international students are not usually catered towards with the existing websites and applications. The app will have connections between job seekers and companies, offer exclusive features such as visa guidance as well as mentorship from professionals. Furthermore, there will be targeted job postings which prioritize graduate level roles as well as sponsorship opportunities which other platforms do not offer.

With these features, I believe that this app will be a useful and great addition for students and meeting their needs by easing transition into employment and retaining talent emerging from universities in the west midlands.

2 User Experience Design

2.1 User Personas

User Persona 1

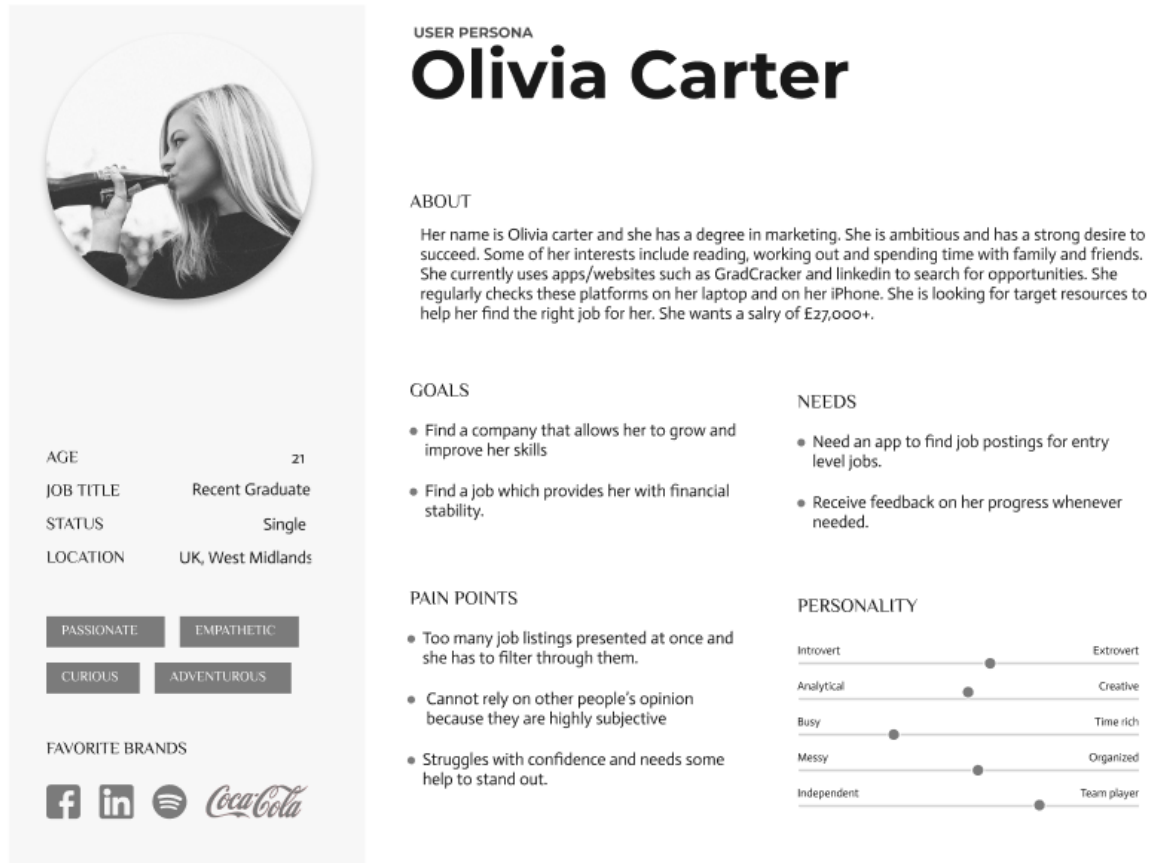


Figure 1: User Persona 1

User Persona 2



AGE 24

JOB TITLE Retail Worker

STATUS Single

LOCATION UK, West Midlands

PASSIONATE ADAPTABLE

HELPFUL OUTGOING

FAVORITE BRANDS

USER PERSONA

Ahmed Khan

ABOUT

His name is Ahmed Khan and he is a recent graduate in computer science. He has studied within the UK but is an international student from Bangladesh. He currently works in retail stores to support himself and he enjoys spending time with his family and friends. He enjoys getting to know other people and speaking to them. He has an interest in coding and enjoys exploring the country. He is currently seeking an entry level job into the computer science roles.

GOALS

- Find a company willing to sponsor him so that he can continue working in the UK
- Find a job which provides him with financial stability.

NEEDS

- Needs to be able to separate job listings by sponsorships

PAIN POINTS

- Too many job listings presented at once and she has to filter through them.
- Cannot rely on other people's opinion because they are highly subjective
- Struggles with confidence and needs some help to stand out.

PERSONALITY

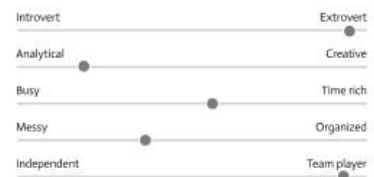


Figure 2: User Persona 2

User Persona 3



AGE 21

JOB TITLE Recent Graduate

STATUS Single

LOCATION UK, West Midlands

CREATIVE EMPATHETIC

CURIOUS RESOURCEFUL

FAVORITE BRANDS

f in Spotify Coca-Cola

USER PERSONA

Emily Turner

ABOUT

Emily Turner is a graduate in graphic designing. She has a visual impairment which makes it difficult to see smaller text. She is also looking for a website that helps her filter out inclusive companies within the west midlands. Remote jobs are ideal for her. She is valued for her high quality work within professional settings. Currently she is unemployed as she has recently graduated and is looking to get back into employment but she is worried about how she should communicate her needs. She would prefer a remote/hybrid role so that she can go at her own pace with her comfortable home office which supports her.

GOALS

- Find an inclusive company that provides her with a supportive environment
- Looking for a remote/hybrid job role.

NEEDS

- Need an app which helps separate remote and on site jobs.
- Easy to use application that does not demand too much precision.

PAIN POINTS

- Lack of transparency in job listings.
- Some websites have too much text on one screen or text is way too small.
- Struggles to communicate her needs to employers

PERSONALITY

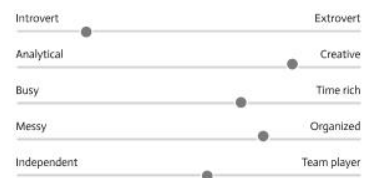


Figure 3: User Persona 3

2.2 User Scenarios

User Scenario 1

Olivia is a recent graduate in Birmingham, and she is in her room scrolling through job listings and opportunities. She is feeling overwhelmed by the job listing and doesn't feel like she stands out enough. She wants to put her degree to use and land her first marketing job. She is seeking an entry role job within marketing with a £27,000+ salary. However, she is unable to do so due to the fierce competition for these entry roles and has trouble finding these roles before they close the timeframe for applications.

She finds the GradBoost app and begins setting up her profile. This app shows workshops and entry level jobs in her area. After signing up, she decides to go to one of these workshops which help develop her skills and resume. In this workshop, she can network with people already in the industry and receive some advice on her resume, skill building and any possible industry entry points. This allows her to feel much more confident when applying to any roles.

User Scenario 2

Ahmed Khan is currently in his flat, frustrated with the job search. As his graduation nears closer, his time in the UK is also ending. He needs to find a job quickly so that he can get a sponsorship. He finds GradBoost, where he signs up and filters out the jobs that do not offer sponsorship. This immediately narrows down his search. He wants to find a software engineering role that matches his skills.

He later sees that there is a premium membership with GradBoost which gives him permissions such as one to one coaching where he can get advice on his career, visa legal advice and CV feedback which would further support him and increase chances of landing a sponsorship.

User Scenario 3

Emily turner has a visual impairment which makes it difficult to see smaller text. She is struggling with other websites as they just throw all the job listings at her with small text. She is currently at her home office which accommodates her needs and comes across GradBoost. She wants to find a hybrid or fully remote job so that she can work at her own pace with her own setup which accommodates her needs. With GradBoost, she can zoom in which reduces the number of job listings shown at once and shows them in bigger text. She also finds screen readers helpful and despises cluttered interfaces.

She can use the filter system to find inclusive companies which will provide her with a supportive environment and begins to apply to the roles.

2.3 User Requirements

Must Have

Search Bar: Find jobs quickly and is easy to use, useful and desirable.

Filters: Filters help users get rid of results they are not interested in and GradBoost will have extra filters to further support the target audience.

Zoom feature: Crucial for accessibility and impaired users as some text may be too small for these users to use.

Scroll: Allows users to go up and down the page. Will be useful when viewing job listings.

Log in/Sign up: Allows for a more personalized experience.

Viewing job listings: Allows users to view, apply and save jobs.

Premium Membership: Gives the user access to extra resources to help them in their career and job search.

Save Job: Allows the user to save jobs and apply to them later.

Profile page: Allows the user to personalize their experience.

Should Have

Good contrast colors: Helps users with impairment.

Clear and concise layout: Prevents users from being overwhelmed with information.

Could Have

Screen reader: Increases accessibility for impaired users.

Job application tracking: Allow users to set a goal to apply to several jobs per day to stay consistent.

Notifications: Remind users about deadlines.

Won't Have

Direct job applications: Instead GradBoost will redirect the user to the company website or contacts.

2.4 Hierarchical Task Analysis

Below are my hierarchical task analysis charts for my must have features.

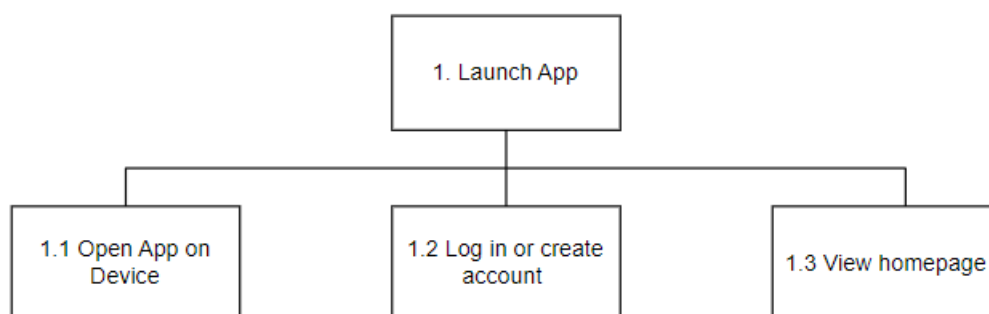


Figure 4: Task 1

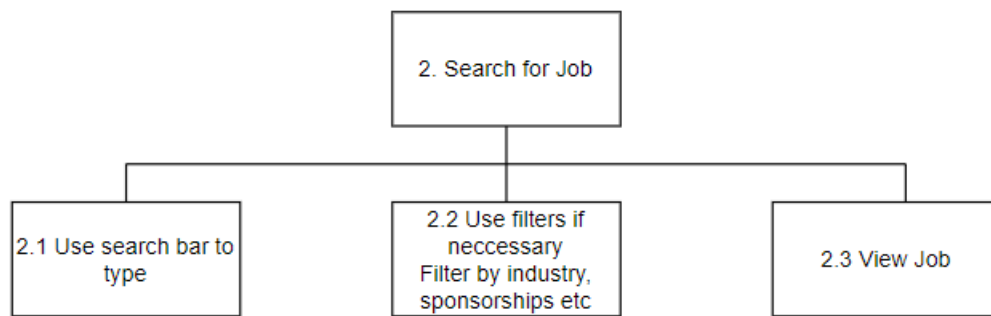


Figure 5: Task 2

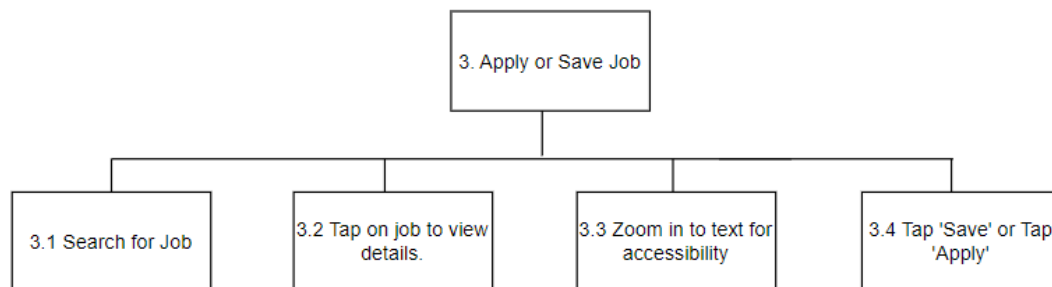


Figure 6: Task 3

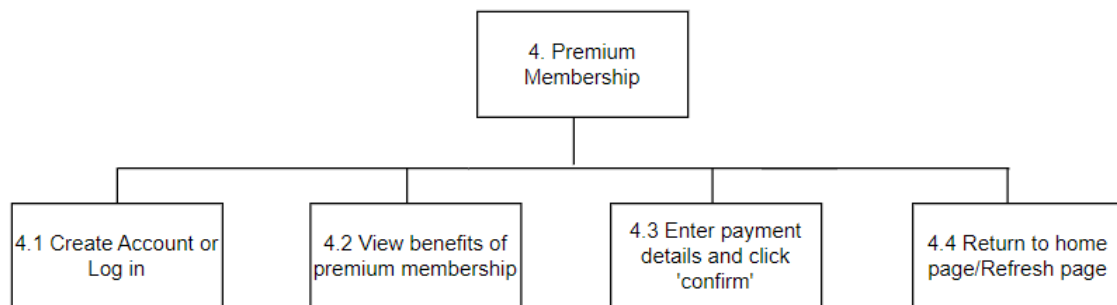


Figure 7: Task 4

My application is designed to help recent graduates, especially international students which struggle to enter industry. The app will have user friendly navigation, accessibility features and intuitive layouts.

The home screen will provide quick access to different parts of the app such as saved jobs, user profile, settings and more. I would also like to include a part in the homepage which shows limited time roles or workshops based on the users' interests. The user can also search for a job which will have a filter menu which can narrow the search down instantly. Filters could be things such as job type, location, inclusive features, industry and if sponsorships are being considered.

After the user searches for a job, a page with relevant results will show and be presented with key information such as salary, job type, industry and a title. The user can then click on it to view more information and possibly save or apply for the job.

The settings and user preferences menu would allow the user to enable accessibility features such as zooming in, font adjustments and more. This ensures that the application is inclusive to everyone.

2.5 Paper prototypes (low-fidelity)

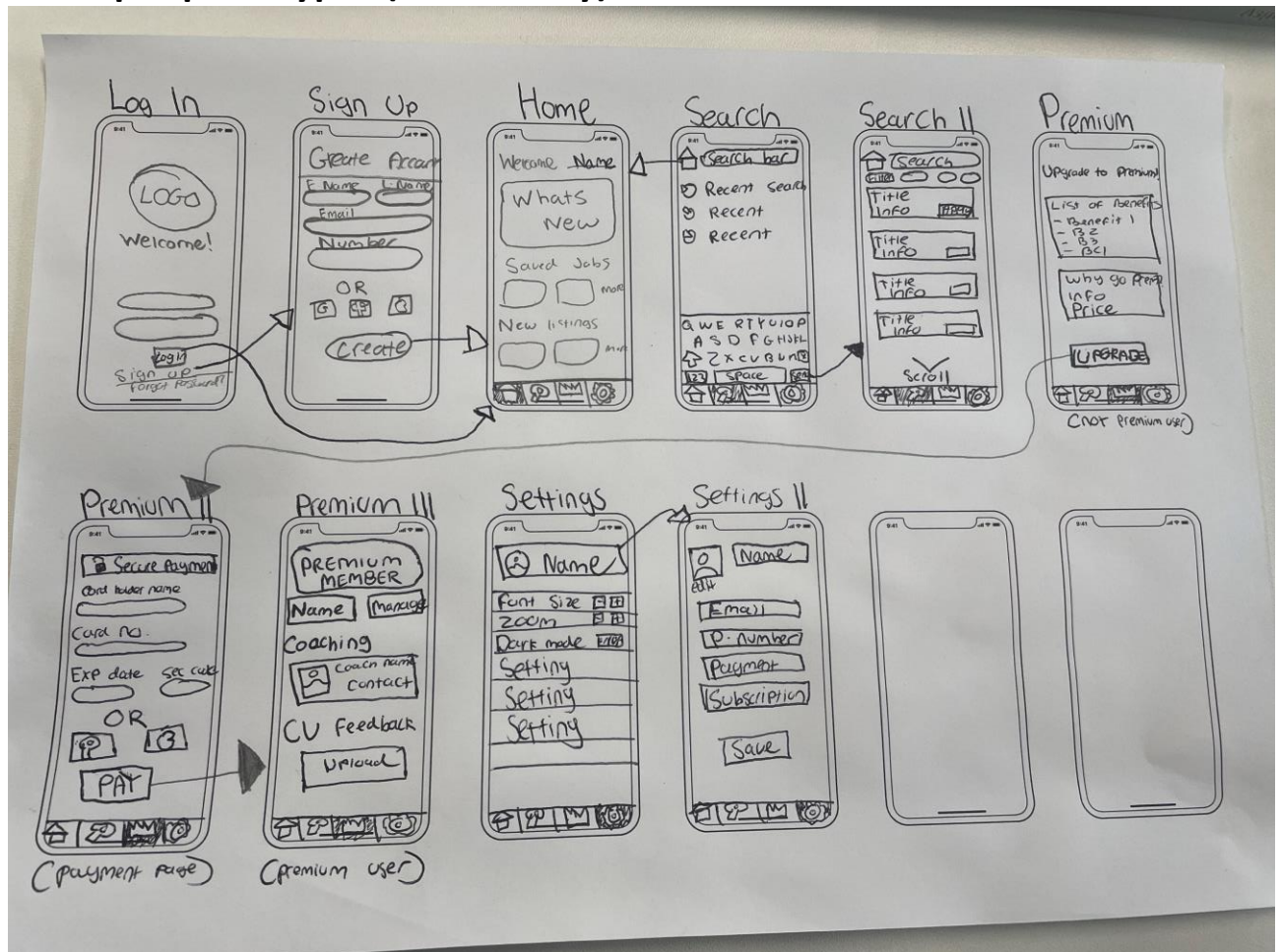


Figure 8: Low fidelity prototypes

During the design process, I was focused on getting the layout sorted out rather than the specifics so that I can further improve it on the wireframes.

Starting off with the log in page, I have decided to go with a more simplistic design rather than a more complicated one. A simple welcome message and fields to input user information as well as forgotten password or sign-up buttons. Similarly, the sign-up page is quite basic and has the convenience of signing up with google, Facebook or apple to improve user experience.

The homepage provides quick access to the apps' features such as saved jobs, a what's new section and a new listings section which provides immediate access to new jobs they can apply to. I have decided to use a bottom navigation as it is already very intuitive.

I have decided to give the searching for jobs feature its own entire page because this is one of the main parts of the app. Recent searches will be shown so that the user can recognize rather than recall. Recognition is much easier than recalling, it has more cues which allows people to remember what they are looking for and find it in a short amount of time. (Budiu,

2014). Furthermore, I have tried to make it so that less than 7 items appear. The average person can only remember approximately 7 items at a time. Only 4 job listings show at once which can prevent overwhelming users.

The premium page as well as the settings page I have mainly focused on the layout. The premium page can also redirect users to the payment page if they are not already a member. The settings page is where the users can access accessibility features such as zooming in and text sizes which will help my third user scenario with a visual impairment.

2.6 Digital wireframes

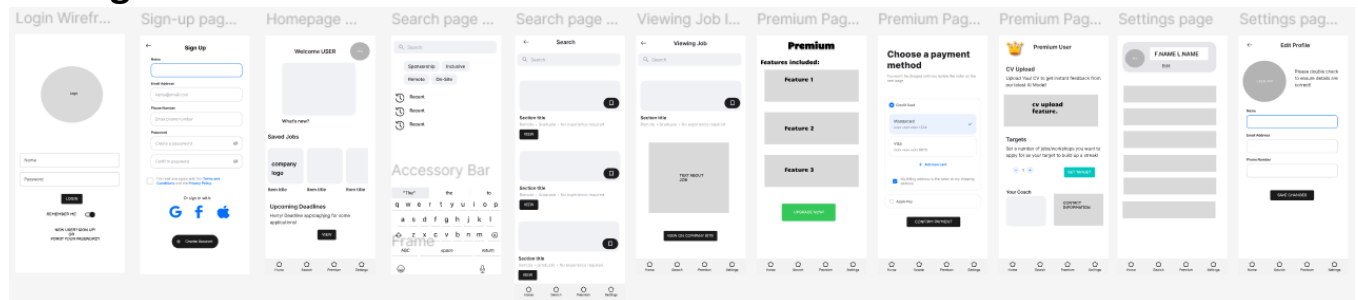


Figure 9: Digital wireframe

I have kept the wireframes nice and basic to start off with. The home page and login page are quite straight forward and intuitive. As these are common formats, the user will immediately know what they need to do. I have also added the option to sign up using a different platform for user convenience. Sub-pages also have a back arrow to help improve usability and navigation.

The homepage is quite basic and not overcrowded. I have attempted to go with a minimalistic design. It has quick access to some of the applications features such as viewing saved jobs and viewing upcoming deadlines.

The whole point of this app is to allow for users to search for jobs in the west midlands. I have decided to make the search page a standalone feature to maintain user focus. Recent searches will be shown which allow people to remember what they are looking for and find it in a short amount of time. (Budi, 2014). The search results page comes up with 3 job listings at a time and the user can then scroll through it. Short term memory can only hold 7 items at a time for about 20 seconds. (Southtree, n.d.) My design choice makes it easier for the user to view the jobs without being overwhelmed by options.

I have designed majority of the pages while keeping in mind the F shaped pattern. The f shaped pattern is a pattern that people scan through websites and applications. They start horizontally and then move down vertically. However, it is not the only pattern. So, I have ensured that all people can use it by making things clear and easy to view. (Pernice, 2017)

The premium page for the non-premium user will just be an advertising page and try to get them to buy the subscription. There is a call-to-action button which stands out a lot due to the color. The payment page is also very intuitive and simple. For the actual premium page, I have tried to make it different to the other pages so that the users feel more privileged.

The settings page is also quite straight forward. The options are listed, and the user can edit their profile through this.

2.7 High-fidelity prototype (mockup)

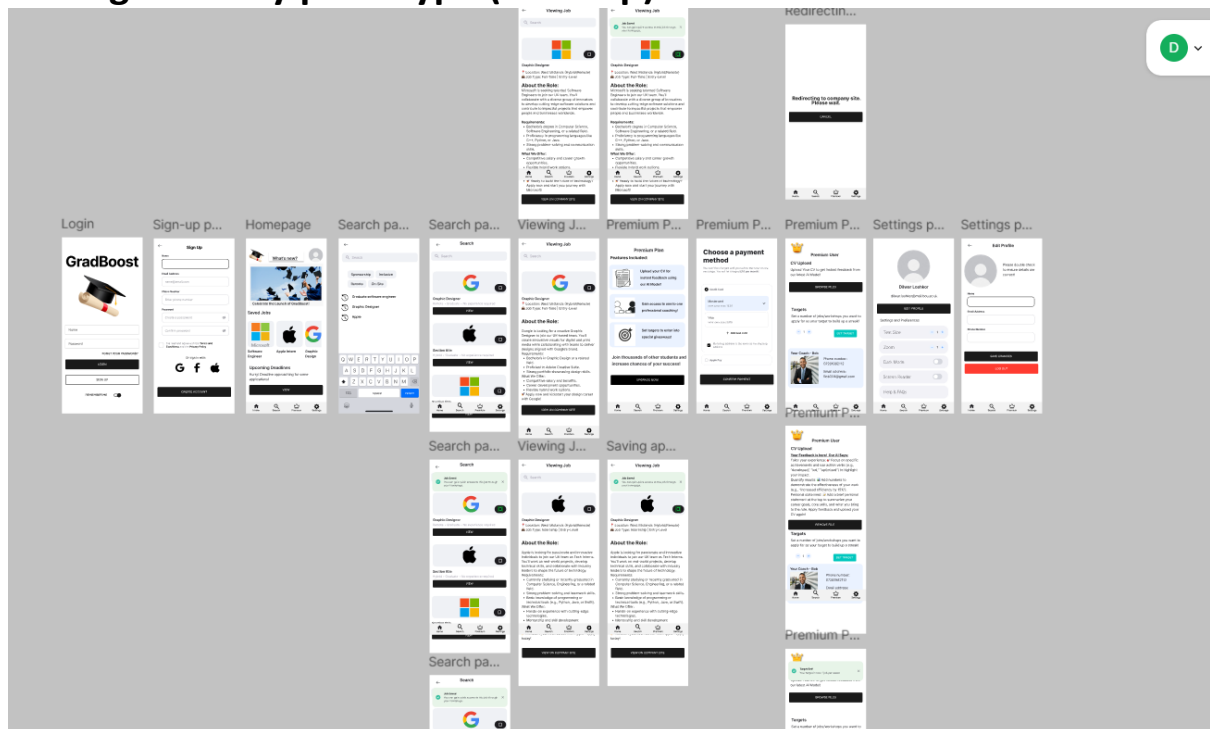


Figure 10: Overview of high-fidelity prototype

The wireframe was what I based my final design off, but I changed many aspects to ensure that it is more user friendly and ensures better user experience. An overview of the changes includes the color schemes of certain pages being filled out. I have also changed the sizes of buttons to make it more friendly for touch screen interactions. The recommended size is 9mm x 9mm. (Uxcel, 2024). The navigation bar is my main example of this as many of the icons were too small in the wireframes. Another major change was many of the extra pages that were added. These pages were added to make the prototype more functional and like a real app. The main examples of this include viewing a job role. I had to create 3 extra pages on Figma so that all 'View' buttons are functional. Furthermore, the premium page is now functional and many of the pages are scrollable.

Throughout the whole design process, I was going for a minimalistic and intuitive design by only keeping the essential features on the screen without cluttering or overwhelming the user. The benefit of this design is that the user will not get distracted by something they will not need. I was also aiming to match the system to the real world. This usability heuristic ensures that no unusual or internal language is used and improves usability and makes it more intuitive. I have done this by using simple wording that users will not have to look up to understand. Furthermore, I have kept things consistent throughout the design which will help the user quickly pick up how to use the system. Jakobs law states that people spend most of their time using other systems. Without consistency, the user would be forced to learn something new which will increase the user's cognitive load. (Nielsen, 1994)

To prevent this, I have used familiar icons such as the home page, the cog for settings and a magnifying glass icon for the search bar. As well as ensuring that there is internal consistency meaning the app itself is similar across all pages.

The image displays two side-by-side mobile app interface mockups. The left mockup is titled 'Login' and features the 'GradBoost' logo at the top, which includes a graduation cap and a rolled diploma. Below the logo are two text input fields labeled 'Name' and 'Password'. A link 'FORGT YOUR PASSWORD?' is positioned below the password field. There are two buttons: a prominent black 'LOGIN' button and a secondary white 'SIGN UP' button. At the bottom, there is a 'REMEMBER ME' label next to a toggle switch. The right mockup is titled 'Sign-up page' and has a back arrow in the top left corner. It is headed 'Sign Up' and contains four text input fields: 'Name', 'Email Address' (with the placeholder 'name@email.com'), 'Phone Number' (with the placeholder 'Enter phone number'), and 'Password' (with the placeholder 'Create a password'). Below the password field is a 'Confirm password' field. A checkbox is followed by the text 'I've read and agree with the Terms and Conditions and the Privacy Policy'. Below this, it says 'Or sign in with:' followed by icons for Google, Facebook, and Apple. A large black 'CREATE ACCOUNT' button is at the bottom.

Figure 11: Login & Sign-up Page

This is the login and sign-up page. They are very simple and intuitive. On both pages I have used clear text fields which tell the user what they need to input. On the login page I have used a primary button as well as a secondary button to differentiate them. This also helps with error prevention because they are less likely to click the wrong option. I also changed button sizes and text field shapes for consistency across the application. As stated by Jakob Nielsen, consistency within the application and with other applications is important for user friendliness. (Nielsen, 1994)

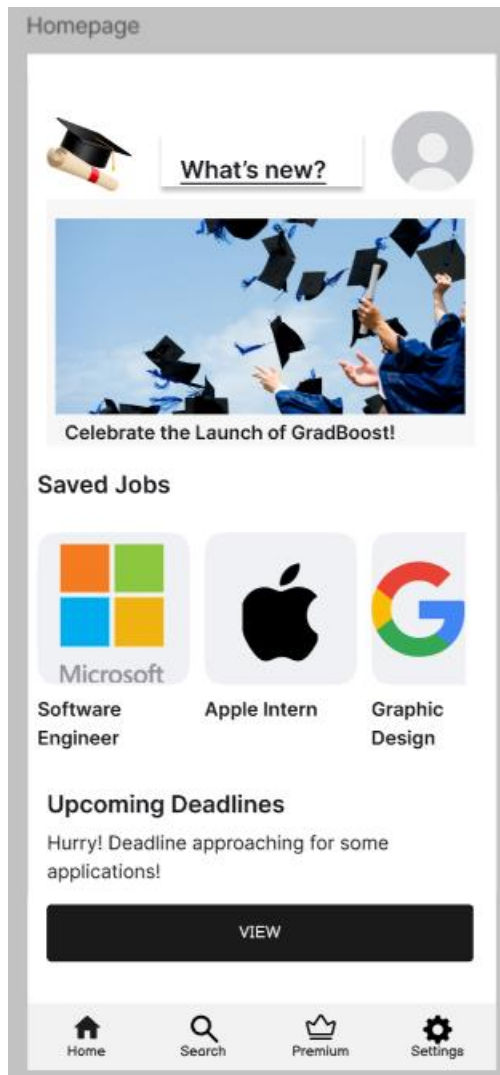


Figure 12: Homepage

After signing up or logging in, the user will be met with this page where they can access saved jobs and view upcoming deadlines. There is a shortcut for more experienced users which allows for some flexibility. Clicking the profile picture will take you directly to the profile page. This is common in other applications too. (Nielsen, 1994)

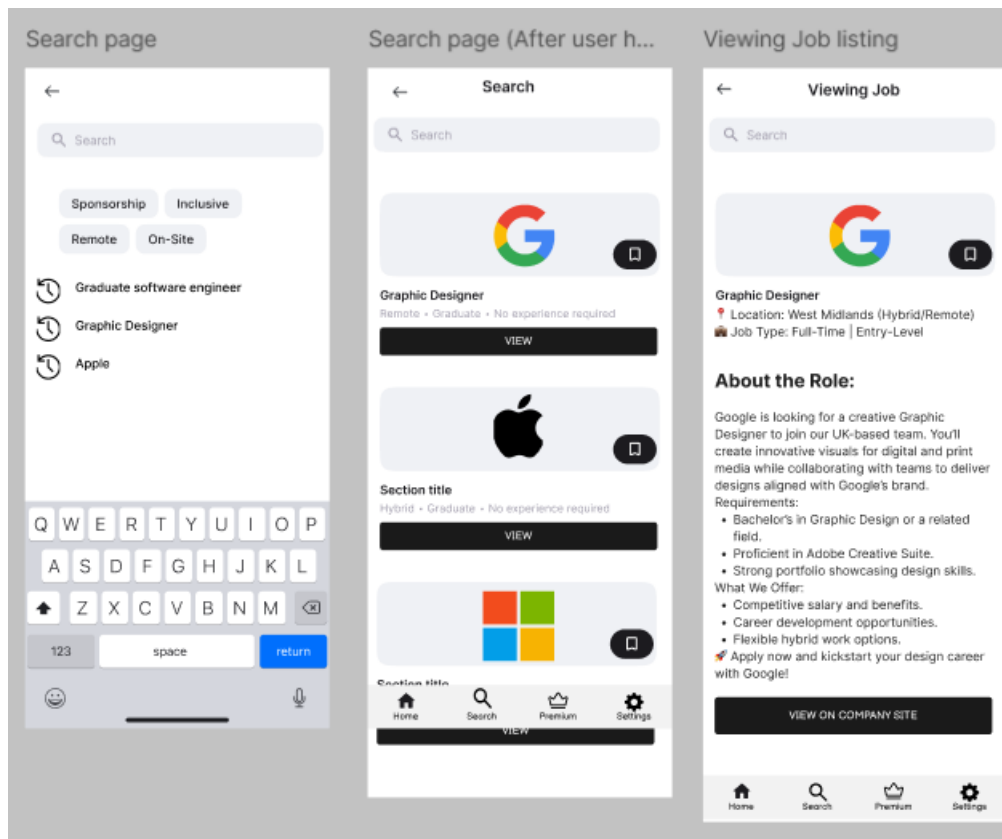
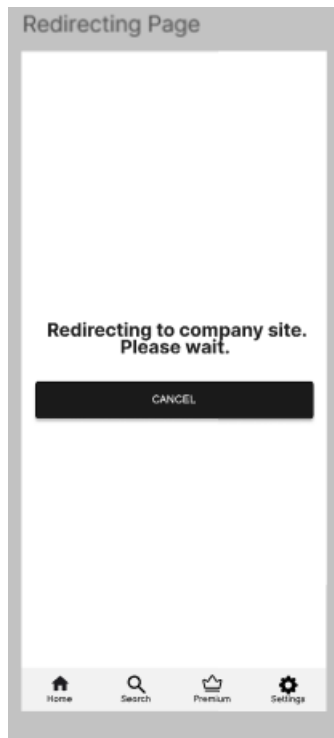


Figure 13: Search page and viewing job

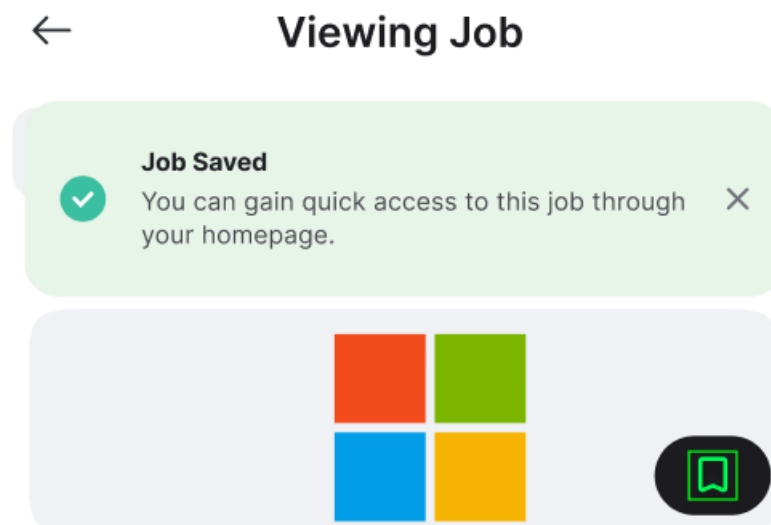
The search page is very simple and intuitive. The filters are at the top of the page, the search bar is also on top. I have added search history. This allows for recognition rather than recall. This makes it easier to use the system as there will be less things the user needs to remember as it is easily retrievable. Back arrows are added to give the user control and prevent errors. (Nielsen, 1994)

Once the user has searched for a job the user can scroll through them and click on view. I have also added the bookmark icon so that the user immediately knows that they are able to save the job. This is a common feature in other apps, so I have followed this industry convention. Once they click on view, the full details of that job will appear. By hiding the full details, the user is less likely to be overwhelmed during their search and will find everything they need to know if they click on 'view'. At the bottom of each page the user can click on 'view on company site' to continue their application process.



Once they have clicked that button, they will be redirected to the company site. To follow the useability heuristic, I have added a cancel button for error prevention. This page also allows the user to see the system status and gives the user control and freedom. Users often make mistakes, and this allows them to undo it. (Nielsen, 1994)

Figure 14: Redirecting page



Similarly, when a user saves a job, a notification will pop up to alert them of the system status and the bookmark symbol will turn green to indicate that it was saved.

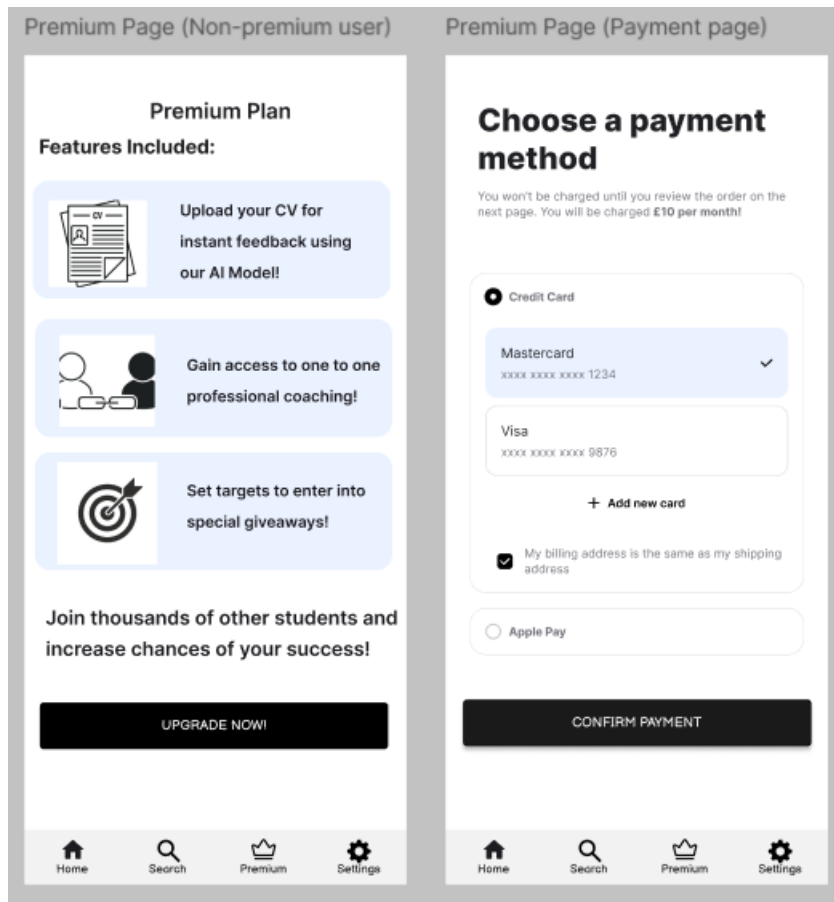


Figure 15: Premium and payment page

The figure above shows the premium page for non-premium users as well as the payment page. The premium page essentially functions as an advertising page for non-premium users to try and persuade them to upgrade. There is an action button at the bottom which takes them to the payment page. The payment page is quite straightforward. I have added multiple payment methods such as apple pay to follow industry convention.

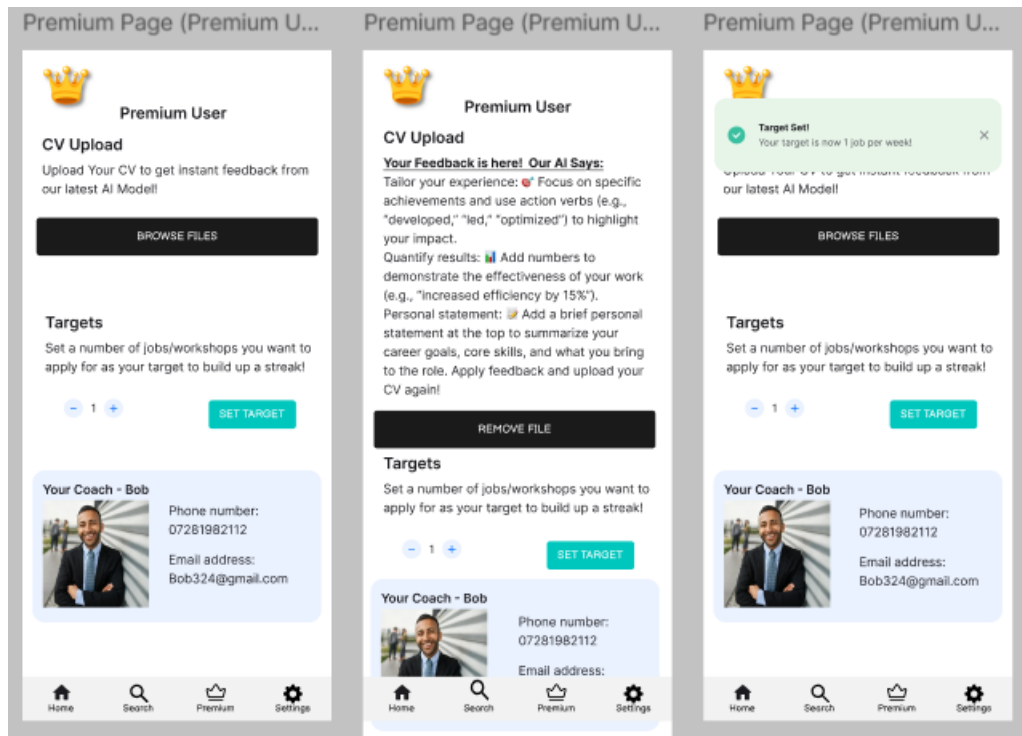


Figure 16: Premium page

The premium page is basic and includes all the features. Users can upload their CV and set targets as well as view their coach's contact details. A notification shows up when the user sets a target similar to how the jobs save. In the wireframe, the premium page looked different to the other pages but in the final prototype I decided to go with consistency.

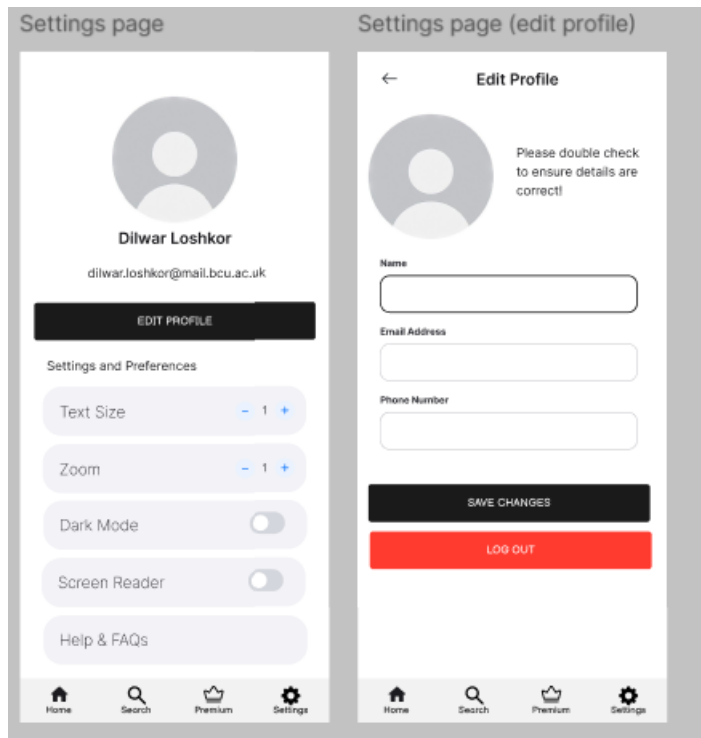


Figure 17: Settings and profile page

This is the settings page where users can find their accessibility features such as zooming in, text sizes, screen readers as well as a help section if required. They can also edit their profile here. There are two buttons. One to save changes and the other to log out. I have made that button red because it is a critical button, and the user understands not to click it unless they want to proceed.

3 Usability testing

3.1 Protocol

Remote testing was conducted for the convenience of participants. Using maze to import my Figma file and allowing them to test it. Followed up with an online survey which included pre-testing questions such as demographics, the SUS questionnaire as well as some open-ended questions. I did encourage users to use a mobile device for the most accurate perspective.

On maze, there were 7 tasks about key features, navigation and functionality of the prototype. The first task was to simply log in or sign up. The second was to search for a job. The third task was saving a job. The fourth task was applying to a job. The fifth task was to buy the membership. The sixth was to edit their profile and the final task was to find the accessibility features.

3.2 Data collection methods

Quantitative data is useful because it allows you to spot patterns and trends that users follow. This could allow me to find issues or confusing sections with my design. It is also quick and easy for the users, which means that they are less likely to rush and easier for me

to analyze (Indeed, 2022). However, it lacks complexity which is why I have also included qualitative data.

To collect quantitative data, I used maze which automatically collected data such as misclicks, time needed, success rates and drop off rates. Click tracking allows me to spot patterns among users and provides usability insights (Aishwarya, 2024). Time needed allows me to find out which tasks were causing the users the most confusion. Success and drop off rates show me if users gave up or not.

Collecting qualitative data is important because it helps you understand the users' thought process and provides more insights. It would help me understand what was good about the system and what the users did not like and the reason behind it which quantitative data does not provide. This allows for further refinement based on user feedback. (contentsquare.com, 2023)

To collect qualitative data, I used Microsoft forms and created a survey. This form included open-ended questions as well as rating questions and the SUS questionnaire. It included 24 questions. I made some optional as I didn't want them to end up rushing the questionnaire.

3.3 Participants

The recruitment process was simple. I contacted a few friends that are students from a variety of courses and ages. Demographics are shown in the figure below:

ID	Age	Technology level	Job searching app usage	Accessibility needs	Occupation
1	26	Beginner	Weekly	No	Student
2	17	Advanced	Never	No	Student
3	19	Advanced	Daily	No	Student
4	20	Advanced	Daily	No	Student
5	24	Advanced	Weekly	No	BSc Computer Science student

Figure 17: User demographics

There are a variety of ages (17-26) as well as a variety of usage in job searching apps. But most of the users are comfortable with technology. None of the users have accessibility needs. I have only chosen students as my application was built for graduates who are looking for an entry level job.

3.4 Results Summary

For task 1 on maze, the success rate was 100%. There was a misclick rate of 23.1% on this task. The average duration was 9.9% with some participants completing the tasks in as short as 2.3 seconds.



Figure 18: Task 2 Statistics

Task 2 had a 100% success rate, but it did have a 47.2% misclick rate. I think that I should have added more success screens as many users viewed a specific job but it would not complete the task which could cause confusion amongst users and skew the data. The task being completed so quickly indicated great intuitiveness.



Figure 18: Task 3 Statistics

Task 3 had a 100% success rate with a 56.7% misclick rate. The average duration was 24.2s. The higher misclick rate could be due to Figma's limitations but it could also be due to small buttons. Enlarging these clickable buttons will improve usability and reduce frustration amongst users.

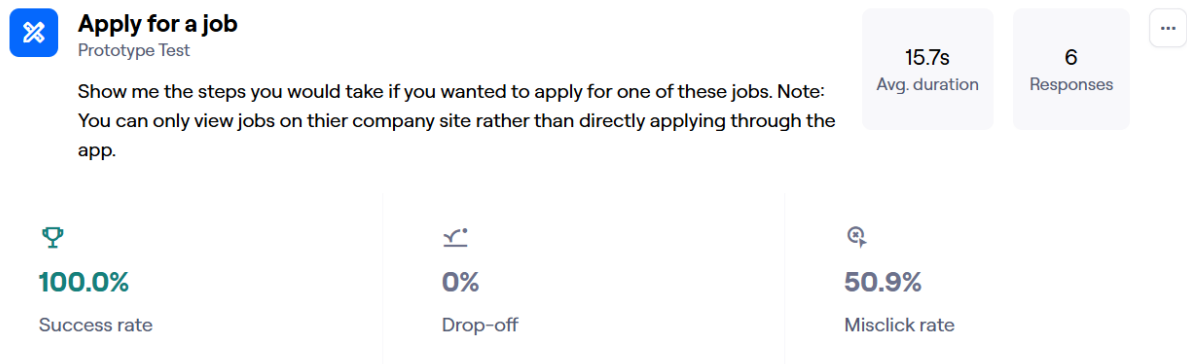


Figure 19: Task 4 Statistics

Task 4 had a 100% success rate with a 50.9% misclick rate and an average duration of 15.7 seconds. This is another case that the fast completion rate shows that users knew what they needed to do and proves that my application is user friendly.

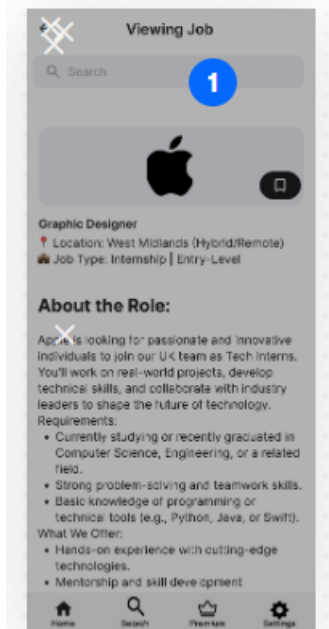


Figure 20: Click tracking

An important note to consider is that one of the participants was struggling to click the back button. They attempted to click it three different times before it worked. This means that the button may have to be bigger or easier to click.



Figure 21: Task 5 Statistics

Task 5 had a lower misclick rate compared to the rest which likely shows that there were not many issues here. However, it did have a longer average duration, but this could be due to the longer task.

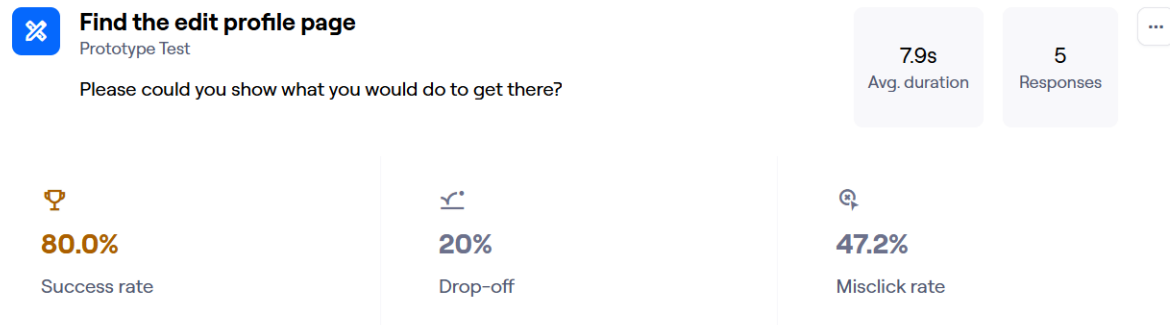


Figure 22: Task 6 Statistics

Task 6 was the first task to have an uncompletion. This could be due to the wording of the task, or they did not fully understand. The participant was seemingly going through random pages. I could redesign this task and provide some hints to get better results.

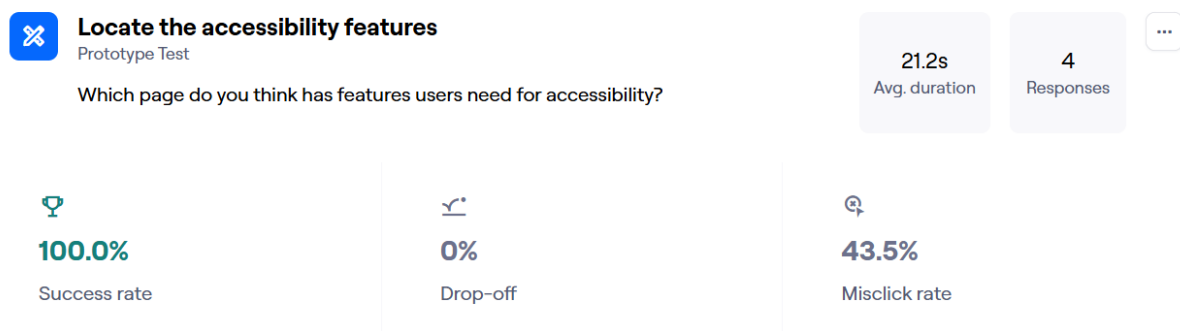


Figure 23: Task 7 Statistics

The final task had an average duration of 21.2s and a 43.5% misclick rate. This data suggests that users could complete the task with ease but the misclick rate is still high. Refining placements of elements could reduce errors and improve efficiency.

Overall, the application demonstrated strong usability with 100% completion on all tasks. However, misclick rates were high due to a variety of factors such as user confusion, button size, live feedback or task clarity. Addressing these issues through larger buttons, clearer instructions, and more success screens would improve these results drastically. Also explaining to participants that it is just a prototype would prevent them from trying to type in text fields or using undeveloped buttons.

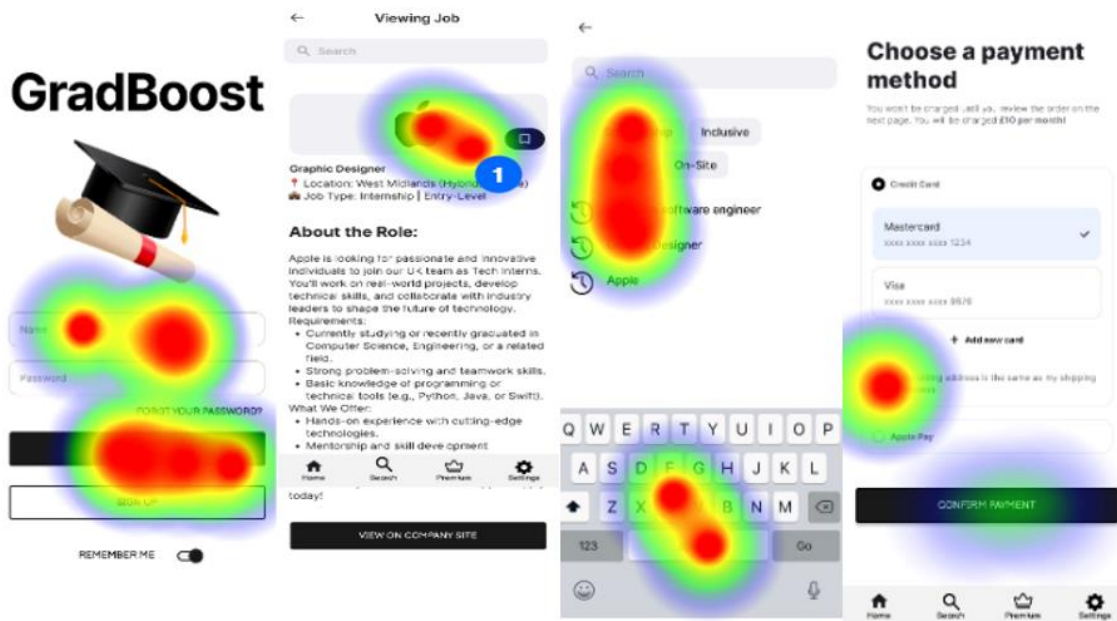


Figure 24: Heatmaps

To explain the misclick rates, I checked the heatmaps provided by maze. Majority of these misclicks were due to the limitations of Figma rather than my design having a usability issue. Users tried typing in text fields, keyboard assets or trying to select options which aren't fully implemented. I could have improved this by informing them in more detail about the maze test.

ID	SUS Score
1	50
2	77.5
3	82.5
4	87.5
5	82.5
AVERAGE SCORE	76

Figure 25: SUS Score table

The SUS scores were very good which shows that the apps useability is higher than average. The average SUS score is 68. (Laubheimer, 2018). However, participant 1 had a very low score. It is difficult to understand why they did not fill in the optional open-ended questions in the survey. But judging from the task durations, it could be that they struggled to understand the wording of certain questions/tasks. They also mentioned that they are not familiar with technology.

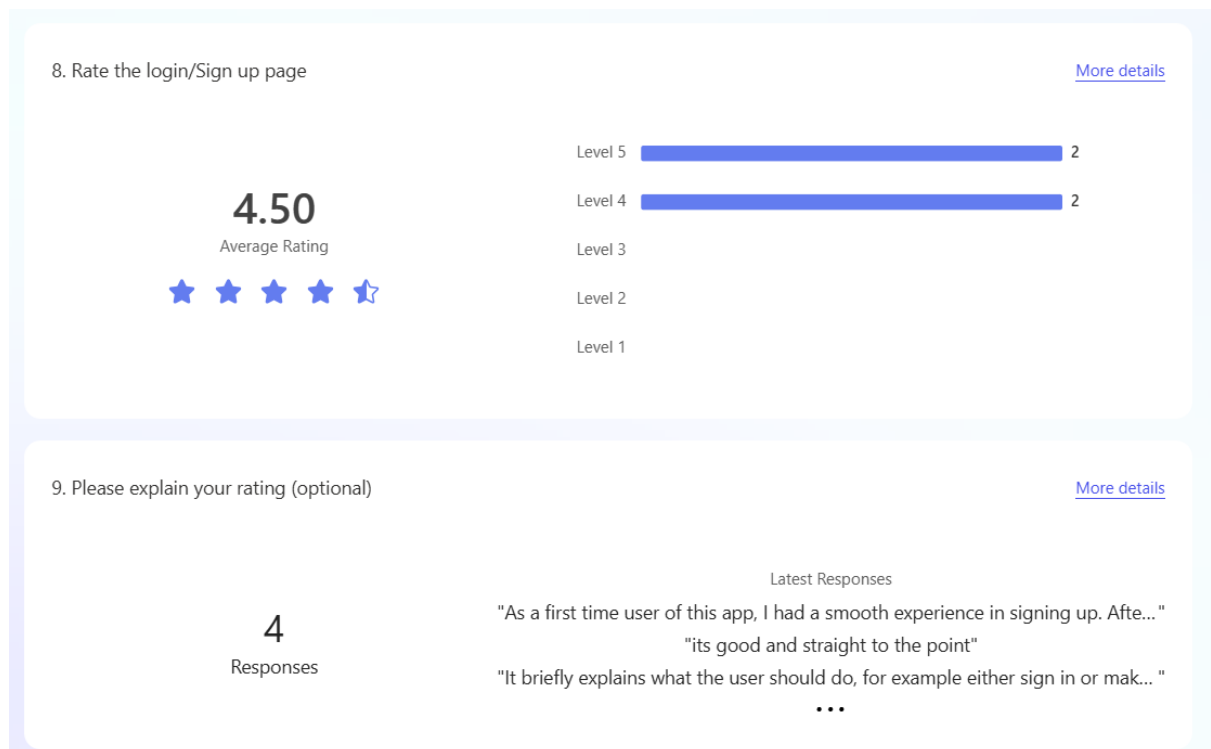


Figure 26: Login/Sign up page data

Users had no issues with the login and sign-up pages and only positive feedback.

11. Please explain your rating (optional)

4 Responses

ID ↑	Name	Responses
1	anonymous	It could use a bit more color to make it more inviting.
2	anonymous	It shows the user everything the website has to offer for example the important things the user might want to see
3	anonymous	its good, but the pictures and text isnt very well alligned.
4	anonymous	The home page consists of key information about some jobs to it easy for me locate. Some changes need to make, for example the text are very congested, if it had more room then easy to read and I would have find less strain in my eyes.

Figure 27: Login/Sign up page data

Users did have some issues with the homepage such as text and image alignment as well as congestion.

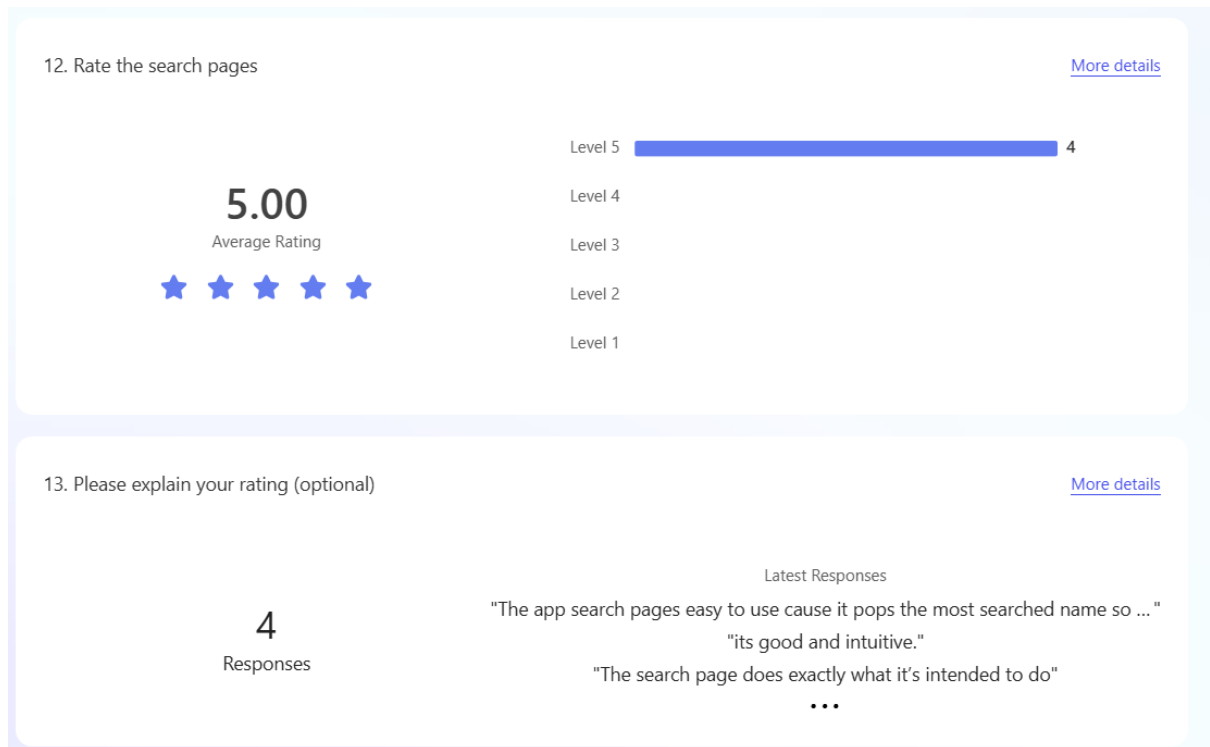


Figure 28: Search page data

Users had no issues with the search page and only gave positive feedback.

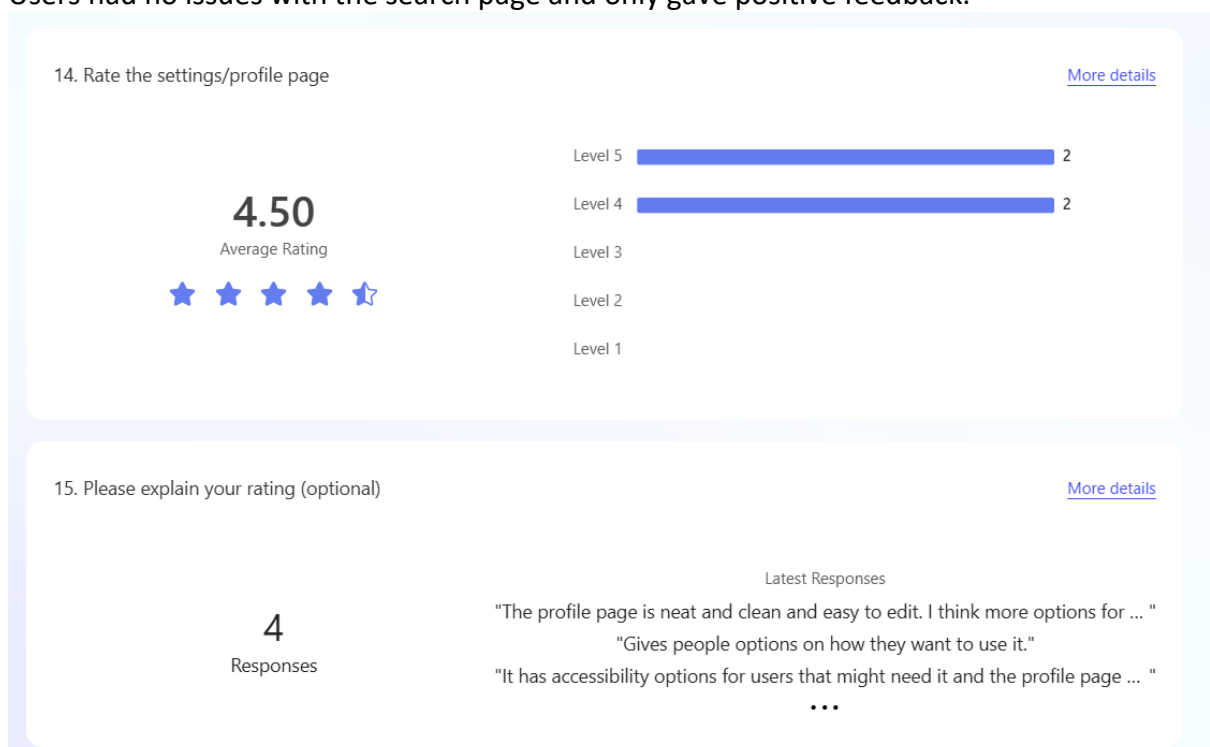


Figure 29: Settings and profile page data

Users had little issues with this page. Some suggestions were to include more personalization and setting options.

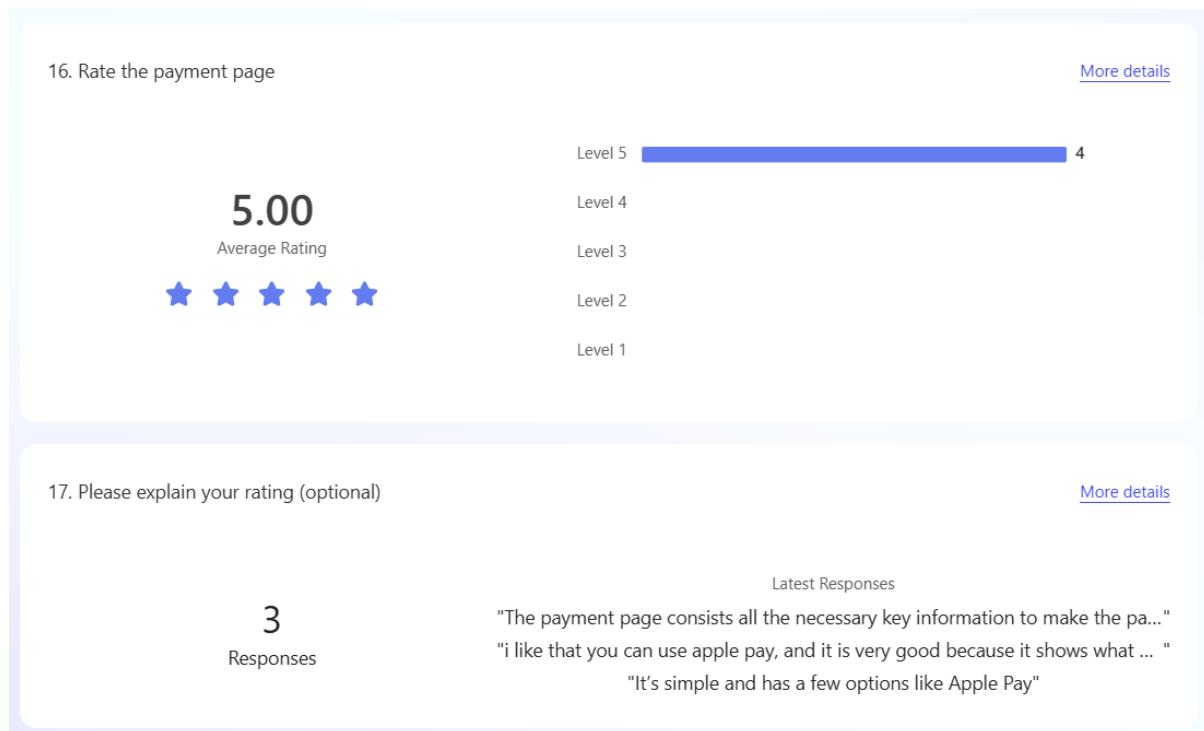


Figure 30: Payment page data

No issues with the payment page, users liked the convenience of features such as apple pay. Users also had no issues with the premium page.

20. Overall, what did you think of the applications design? Explain why when possible.

5 Responses

ID ↑	Name	Responses
1	anonymous	The design is good but there is room for improvements
2	anonymous	The application design is a little bit bland a few colors in it would splash life into the site, or a few images here and there,
3	anonymous	The design is simple and any individual would be able to navigate around
4	anonymous	Its very good, easy to use, and accessible by all kinds.
5	anonymous	The application I would say is very good. The signup/login, payment process was smooth and interactive. The color choice and font size was nice as well. Most of the things the app proves has dedicated page so easy to use. Some changes need to make like give more room and space for the content in home page.

Figure 31: Participant overall thoughts

All participants enjoyed the design of my application but mentioned that there are improvements such as issues with the homepage.

21. Was there any features that you found difficult to use? If so, please explain why.

5 Responses

ID ↑	Name	Responses
1	anonymous	Navigating through was a bit difficult
2	anonymous	No features were difficult they were all fairly simple.
3	anonymous	In my opinion none of the features were hard to use as it was straight forward
4	anonymous	No
5	anonymous	I found difficulty looking for jobs. I had to take some time to look where are all the jobs are located. But if a dedicated page was created for jobs then it would have been for me to search or filter jobs according to my choice of interest..

Figure 32: Participant difficulties

Participant 1 mentioned that navigation was tough but did not mention how. But they then go on to say they found navigation neutral in the next question. Participant 5 mentioned that they had difficulty with jobs and wanted a separate page although that is what the search page functions as. Overall, positive feedback from the users.

23. Please answer these questions about the ease of use.

5 Responses

ID ↑	Name	Responses	
		How easy was it to find the features you were looking for?	How easy was it to navigate through the app?
1	anonymous	Neutral	Neutral
2	anonymous	Easy.	Very Easy
3	anonymous	Very Easy	Very Easy
4	anonymous	Very Easy	Very Easy
5	anonymous	Neutral	Easy.

Figure 33: Participant navigation opinions

Most users found it easy to navigate through.

4 Analysis/Discussion

Overall, from the feedback received, my application seems usable and intuitive. I did not receive major/critical complaints during the testing. SUS scores exceeded the benchmark of 68 and qualitative data was mainly positive reflecting usability. Using maze was very helpful and convenient for both me and the users as data was collected automatically. However, its insights are still quite limited compared to other methods.

After analyzing the feedback several improvements emerged. The homepage was critiqued for alignment issues and clutter. In response, I designed it in a clean simple way by separating features into subpages and removing unnecessary icons. This is much less overwhelming. Also, Highlighting the current age in the navigation bar improves orientation and useability. This redesign aligns further with Jakob law by maintaining consistency and reducing cognitive overload.

Some users also mentioned that color was needed to make it stand out more. Without compromising my minimalistic design, I incorporated color through my navigation bar and buttons. This approach addressed user concerns while enhancing the overall experience.

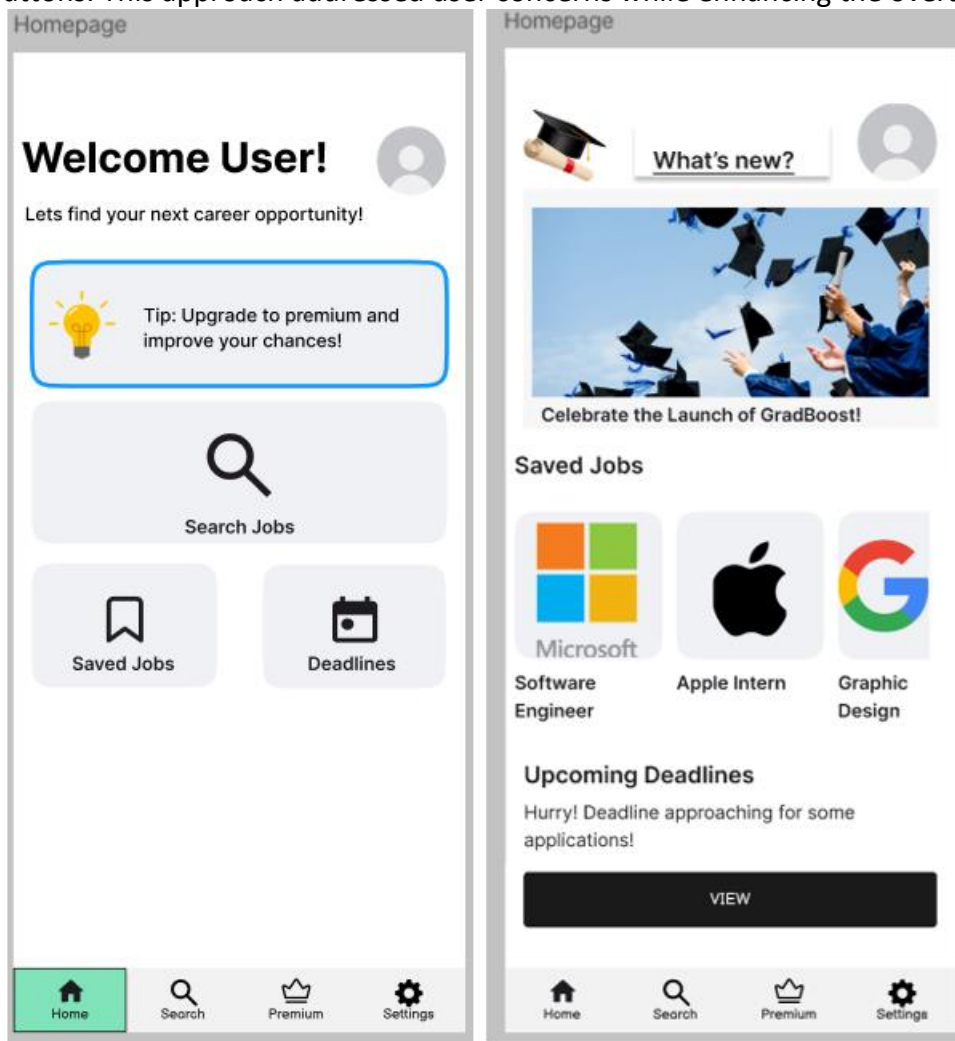


Figure 34: After AND Before Homepages

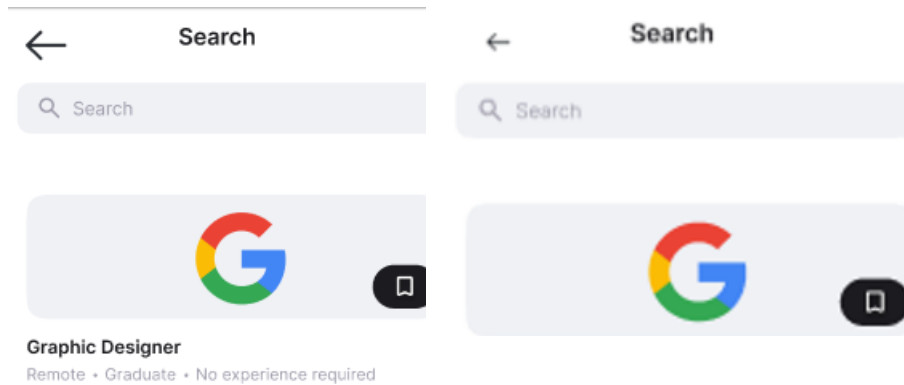


Figure 35: Back button changes. (After and Before)

Using data from heatmaps I also found out that these back buttons were too small. I have made them bigger, ensuring compliance with touch screen guidelines (Uxcel, 2024) to address this issue and improve usability.

Some other usability techniques I could have used include the A/B testing. This is where users receive 2 different versions of a design and data is collected to see which one performs better. The strength of this is that you can test design layouts such as my homepage. You can also see how many users complete a task based on real behavior. However, this could take much more time and resources to develop and only compares two designs rather than showing underlying issues (Rees, 2010). You may also need a bigger sample for meaningful data.

Another technique I could have used is the think-aloud protocol. This is where the user verbalizes their thought process and provides more insights on behaviors. The benefits of this is that it is flexible and can be done at any point in the development cycle of the product. It could also give you more complex insights into user behaviors. However, this is quite unnatural and might distract the user from testing as they also need to speak to you. There is also a risk of them not saying much until the testing is over. This means you will need to prompt them. (Nielsen, 2012)

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Appendices

Microsoft Forms Used to collect data

Usability Testing Form

Please answer honestly and give detailed answers where possible. It should not take very long. There are 24 questions.

1. Do you consent to having your data used for my report? (Data is anonymous and only contains the maze testing and what you have entered in this form) *

☐ Yes

☐ No

2. Please enter your age *

Enter your answer

3. How would you rate your comfort level with technology *

☐ Beginner

☐ Intermediate

☐ Advanced

Figure 36.1: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

4. How often do you use job searching apps? *

☐ Daily

☐ Weekly

☐ Monthly

☐ Never

5. Do you have any accessibility needs? (E.g Visual or mobility) *

☐ Yes

☐ No

6. What is your occupation? (E.g Student) *

Enter your answer

Figure 36.2: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

7. Please answer the **System Usability Scale** Questionnaire based on your experience with the app *

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly
I think that i would like to use this system frequently	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I found the system unnecessarily complex	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I thought that the system was easy to use	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I think that i would need the support of a technical person to use the system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I found the various functions in this system were well integrated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I thought that there were too much inconsistency in this system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system quickly	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I found the system very cumbersome (Complex, difficult) to use	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I felt confident using the system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I needed to learn a lot of things before i could get going with this system	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Figure 36.3: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

8. Rate the login/Sign up page *



9. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

10. Rate the homepage *



11. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

12. Rate the search pages *



13. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

Figure 36.4: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

14. Rate the settings/profile page *



15. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

16. Rate the payment page *



17. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

18. Rate the premium page *



19. Please explain your rating (optional)

Enter your answer

Figure 36.5: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

20. Overall, what did you think of the applications design? Explain why when possible. *

Enter your answer

21. Was there any features that you found difficult to use? If so, please explain why. *

Enter your answer

22. Is there any features missing that you think would enhance the users experience? *

Enter your answer

23. Please answer these questions about the ease of use. *

	Challenging	Difficult	Neutral	Easy.	Very I
How easy was it to find the features you were looking for?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How easy was it to navigate through the app?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

24. If you have any other extra feedback, please let me know! If you have issues with a specific page that would be helpful to type in this field. (Optional)

Enter your answer

Figure 36.6: Usability Testing Form used to collect data

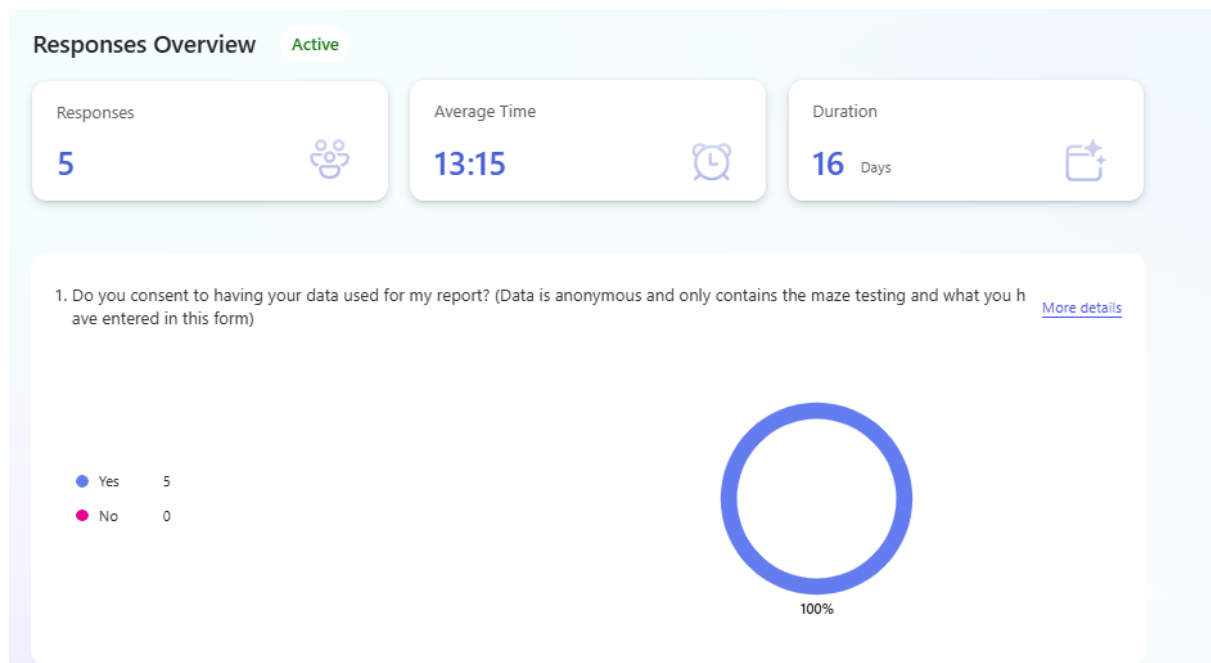


Figure 37: Consent data – All participants have consented

User Persona Descriptions

My first user persona is a graduate from the UK. Her name is Olivia Carter and is 22 years old with a bachelor's degree in marketing. Her personality is ambitious and has a strong desire to succeed but she has trouble having the confidence to stand out from amongst the crowd. Her motivations include being in a company where she can grow, develop her skills and make a good income to provide her with some financial stability. She is a recent graduate and works shifts bi-weekly. Some of her interests and hobbies include reading books, working out, spending spare time on video games and with family and friends. Other apps she uses include GradCracker and LinkedIn to try and search for graduate opportunities. Olivia uses an Acer laptop and has an iPhone 12.

She is seeking an entry role job within marketing with a £27,000+ salary. However, she is unable to do so due to the fierce competition for these entry roles and has trouble finding these roles before they close the timeframe for applications.

My second user persona has recently graduated in the UK with a bachelor's degree in computer science. His name is Ahmed. He is 24 years old and is an international student from Bangladesh. They have been working in Tesco to support themselves while studying and make around £240 a week. He has an outgoing personality and likes to speak and get to know many other people. His motivations are to work for a better life and make his family proud. He occasionally sends money back home as the British pound is worth more than his home currency. His interests and hobbies include doing coding exercises, exploring the country and spending time with friends. The gadgets he uses include a Samsung S20 and a HP Laptop.

He is currently seeking an entry role into the computer science field. However, the main issue is that he cannot find any roles that are willing to sponsor him so that he can continue to stay in the UK. Many international students face this issue, and this is where my app would come into use.

Tools Used

Figma

Maze

Microsoft Forms